



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Cair Paravel Latin School

School Website: <https://cpls.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: ACCREDITED MEMBER SCL: MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Cair Paravel Latin School (CPLS) presents a robust Classical Christian program. Public materials from CPLS consistently frame education as formation in truth, goodness, and beauty within a Christian and classical framework. The school foregrounds the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric), a strong Great Books/Great Conversation orientation, and explicit engagement with Latin and Ancient Greek (including a language option for Ancient Greek). Public materials frequently articulate a mission built around virtue, character, and a teleological aim toward Christ-centered human flourishing, rather than solely workforce preparation. Evidence from CPLS communications shows an intentional partnership with families and a community orientation around shared faith and classical formation. Based on the publicly available content, CPLS aligns with a CLASSICAL orientation across all six evaluated categories.

Key evidentiary anchors include CPLS's mission statement linking education to the Lordship of Jesus Christ and community formation; explicit articulation of the Great Conversation and Great Books in the curriculum and culture; the presence of grammar, logic, and rhetoric across grade levels; a strong emphasis on virtue and formation; visible faculty exemplars and leadership; and a family/community orientation with parent involvement and open-campus expectations. See supporting citations throughout the category sections.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The CPLS mission emphasizes formation under Christ: "cultivate classically trained, lifelong learners, committed to the Lordship of Jesus Christ, who will enrich their community and God's kingdom."
- Public faculty/testimony materials underscore Christ-centered teaching and personal faith integration (e.g., staff narratives describing Christian witness and dependence on Christ in daily life).
- Widespread claim that CPLS education is rooted in faith and biblical worldview; themes of truth, goodness, beauty appear repeatedly in public messages (e.g., "truth, beauty, and goodness" referenced in campaign and mission materials).
- JCL page explicitly frames classical education within a Christian/intentional context (sociocultural/philosophical formation tied to classical aims).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; worship/faith; Lordship of Christ; sacred worldview; reverence and wonder (via explicit faith-integrated framing and daily-life testimonies).

- Negative indicators: none evident in public CPLS materials. No explicit relativism or secular-humanist signals detected in the public-facing content cited here.

Why this rating

- The school publicly situates education within a Christian metaphysical frame (Lordship of Christ, biblical worldview) and ties virtue formation to the curriculum and daily life. The presence of explicit transcendentals (truth, beauty, goodness) and the integration of faith across school life strongly support a Classical orientation in this category.

Frequency/Quantification

- Positive keywords observed (approximate): 6–8 distinct terms (truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, faith/theology, worship/Lordship, reverence/wonder) across sources. Negative keywords observed: 0.
- Estimated ratio: predominantly positive (roughly 100% of captured religious-metaphysical indicators are positive in the available materials).

Rank justification

- CLASSICAL: Clear alignment with transcendentals, virtue formation, theology integration, and liturgical/community signals.

Citations: mission statement and campaign language showing truth/goodness/beauty and Christ-centered framing.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Mission statements emphasize formation and human flourishing under a Christian telos rather than purely job/work preparation. “The aim of CPLS is not to prepare me for college, scholarships, or a job, but to prepare me to live the good life, by becoming like Christ and loving that which is true, good, and beautiful.”
- Core phrase: “cultivate classically trained, lifelong learners” signals formation as primary end.
- The Great Conversation and Great Books framing appears as a central curricular and cultural aim, aligning knowledge with timeless truths rather than narrow vocational ends.
- Philosophical/teleological framing: emphasis on truth, goodness, beauty as real and knowable, and human excellence through a classical framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful, liberal education, classical mission, scholé (conceptual), great conversation.
- Negative indicators present: explicit workforce-preparation language is avoided in the public mission; a counter-example appears in the ACT-based communication which frames college readiness as a byproduct, not a primary aim (negative signal regarding work/college as sole end).

Why this rating

- The school’s stated aims center formation, virtue, and a teleological pursuit consistent with classical education. The byproduct view of college/work readiness aligns with the classical-Christian framework rather than a modern workforce orientation.

Frequency/Quantification

- Positive keywords observed: approximately 5–7 distinct terms (formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, true/good/beautiful, liberal education/great conversation).
- Negative keywords observed: 1 explicit workforce/college-as-end notion appears only as a byproduct, not as the primary aim.

- Ratio: predominantly positive with a single contrasting note on outcomes emphasis; overall, CLASSICAL in spirit.

Rank justification

- CLASSICAL: Formation-focused, virtue-centered, and anchored in timeless truth-laden goals rather than instrumental workforce precursors.

Citations: mission statement and “what is the good life” framing; Great Conversation emphasis.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Structural stages of the trivium are explicitly named in CPLS resources (grammar, logic, rhetoric), with articulation of the aims of each stage. “Rhetoric School” describes the culmination of the trivium and the role of rhetoric in senior-year capstone work.
- Great Books / Great Conversation orientation appears in curricular/cultural materials (e.g., “the Great Conversation” concept in public materials; references to Great Books in the context of philosophy and literature).
- Languages: CPLS public materials highlight Latin and Greek as foundational to classical education; Ancient Greek is noted as a language option, with JCL highlighting Greek as a distinctive feature. This signals a strong language curriculum aligned with classical aims.
- History and Western civilization framing, primary sources, and a history-led approach to many subjects are described in curricular communications and blog posts.
- Public materials discuss the “Great Conversation” and engagement with classics (e.g., Homer, Plato, Augustine, Shakespeare) as central to curriculum.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), great books / great conversation, Latin/Greek, history/Western civilization, primary sources, classical languages, recitation/narration, and the use of sacred/humanities content through biblical worldview integration.
- Negative indicators present: minimal reference to a strictly “project-based” or STEM-first framing in curriculum materials; a few modernized modes (coding in a classical setting) appear as student-led extras, but do not dominate the public curriculum narrative. The lexicon lists a negative signal for project-based dominance, which does not appear to be the curricular emphasis in CPLS’s primary materials.

Why this rating

- The curriculum is clearly anchored in grammar/logic/rhetoric, Great Books integration, Latin/Greek, and a history/Western civilization emphasis. The presence of Great Books and the trivium, plus explicit language instruction, aligns strongly with classical education.

Frequency/Quantification

- Positive keywords observed: 8–10 distinct items (grammar/logic/rhetoric; Great Books/Great Conversation; Latin/Greek; history/Western civilization; primary sources; classical languages; recitation/narration; sacred arts/hymnody).
- Negative keywords observed: 0–1 instance of project-based dominance appears in the broader lexicon, but CPLS materials do not foreground such framing in the core curriculum (rather, it emphasizes classical methods).
- Ratio: Predominantly positive (CLASSICAL in interpretation).

Rank justification

- CLASSICAL: Curriculum is clearly built around trivium, Great Books, classical languages, and a historical/western civilizational study.

Citations: Trivium/Great Books/Latin-Greek language focus; history and Western civilization framing; Great Conversation language in public materials.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials describe a pedagogy consistent with classical education, including a mix of Socratic-style discussion in upper levels and rhetoric-focused work in the Rhetoric School, with emphasis on memory, recitation, and disciplined writing (e.g., “Rhetoric School” profile and senior-thesis/presentation emphasis).
- Lower- and grammar-stage pedagogy highlighted through the structure of grammar/logic/rhetoric and a focus on memory work, recitation, and the idea of “the Great Conversation” (as a pedagogy that integrates across the curriculum).
- The public materials emphasize the value of contemplation, wonder, and a classical sequence, with emphasis on forming judgment through dialogue and rhetorical practice.
- Examples of active student engagement with classical topics (e.g., JCL, Greek language exposure, world travel as experiential context for learning) indicate pedagogy that blends contemplative elements with rigorous inquiry.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Socratic/seminar style, narration/recitation, chanting/memory work, Unterricht in the Trivium, seminar/Paideia approaches, rhetoric, speech/debate, and the integration of memory work and liturgical/calendar coordination.
- Negative indicators present: Public materials do not emphasize purely experiential or project-based pedagogy as the main approach; when modern projects occur (e.g., coding clubs), they are framed as supplementary rather than dominant pedagogical models. The classical lexicon notes strong signals against exclusive project-based learning in core classical pedagogy.

Why this rating

- The pedagogy described aligns with classical teaching methods (grammar/logic/rhetoric progression, memory work, recitation, and rhetoric/semantics across the high school). Socratic/seminar norms and higher-level rhetoric emphasis are present in the program descriptions and course structures.

Frequency/Quantification

- Positive keywords observed: 6–8 (Socratic/seminar, narration/recitation, chanting/memory work, scholé/rest/ contemplation signals, Paideia/seminar, rhetoric, speeches/debates).
- Negative keywords observed: 1 (occasional note of non-core project-based emphasis in broader lexicon; not central to CPLS core pedagogy).
- Ratio: Predominantly positive (CLASSICAL) in publicly described pedagogy.

Rank justification

- CLASSICAL: Pedagogical methods reflect canonical classical practices (grammar/logics/rhetoric, memory, Socratic-style inquiry in upper levels, rhetoric in the senior years).

Citations: Rhetoric/upper-school pedagogy; memory/recitation; Great Conversation framing; lower/grammar stage language.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials present a cadre of long-tenured, mission-aligned teachers and administrators who model virtue and Christian faith, with quotes from staff that emphasize calling, personal testimony, and

life in Christ as motivators for teaching. Examples include the Head of School and multiple faculty spotlights/testimonies.

- Faculty bios emphasize continuity, leadership, and engagement with classical texts and Great Ideas (e.g., teachers referencing Great Books, philosophy, and classical education in their pedagogy).
- Public materials show staff as integrally connected to the school's mission and vision (e.g., staff pages citing years of service, educational background, and personal faith testimony).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: model teachers and mentors; living curriculum (implied by staff narratives and long tenure); collegial, faith-centered faculty culture; portraits of teacher ideals and student ideals; teacher as guides in classical formation.
- Negative indicators present: none evident in the public-facing materials. No "facilitator" or overly managerial language dominant in core materials.

Why this rating

- The public-facing materials consistently describe faculty as core to the program (long-tenured, faith-informed, committed to classical formation), aligning with the Classical model's emphasis on the faculty as mentors and living exemplars.

Frequency/Quantification

- Positive keywords observed: 6–8 distinct faculty-formation signals (long-tenured teachers, personal faith testimony, teacher as mentor, faculty spotlights, living-curriculum implications).
- Negative keywords observed: 0

Rank justification

- CLASSICAL: Faculty are framed as the living embodiment and core of the curriculum, with explicit mentorship and virtue modeling.

Citations: Head of School profile; staff spotlights; faculty testimonials; long-tenure notes.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- CPLS communicates a partnership with parents and a sense of parental involvement in school life (e.g., posts and pages that emphasize collaboration with families and "co-teaching" relationships). Public materials describe parent involvement as central to classical formation.
- There are explicit references to parent formation and community-building activities (e.g., book studies, seminars, and family engagement content connected to classical aims).
- The school maintains an open-door approach (e.g., Get directions and tour opportunities; parent visitation access) and a strong communications/handbook ecosystem. Public pages show an admission-/tour flow inviting parental participation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: partnership with parents; parental formation; public events and seminars; open campus culture; family liturgy alignment in broader classical education framing; classical parent community orientation (e.g., "parents as co-teachers" concept widely echoed in classical lexicon and CPLS messaging).
- Negative indicators present: the public content largely frames parents positively; no explicit consumer/customer language dominating the core materials (which would be a negative signal in other school contexts). The content contributes to a co-teaching/community orientation rather than consumer framing.

Why this rating

- CPLS presents a consistent, cooperative model with parents as partners and co-educators in the formation process; open tours and parental involvement are repeatedly encouraged.

Frequency/Quantification

- Positive keywords observed: 4–6 distinct terms (partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, seminars, family engagement, open campus).
- Negative keywords observed: 0

Rank justification

- CLASSICAL: The school emphasizes parent collaboration and family formation as a central part of classical education.

Citations: Parent/teacher collaboration language; tour/admissions openness; family engagement content.

Aggregate assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: CLASSICAL
- Element 4: CLASSICAL
- Element 5: CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall: CLASSICAL

What Would Move the Needle

- Not applicable here, as the aggregate classification is fully CLASSICAL. No category reaches a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL status that would require needle-moving recommendations.

ABSTRACT

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Cair Paravel Latin School (CPLS) demonstrates a robust Classical Christian orientation across six evaluation categories: Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, School Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, and Parents & Community. Evidence from CPLS's public-facing materials shows a teleological, virtue-centered mission anchored in Christian theism; a curriculum built on the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Great Books (Great Conversation); languages (Latin and Ancient Greek) as foundational elements; classic pedagogy combining memory work, dialogue, and rhetorical practice; faculty as virtuous mentors; and an engaged parents/community partnership.

- Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CPLS presents a Christ-centered telos with references to the Lordship of Jesus Christ, as well as faith-based formation and truth/goodness/beauty. Positive cues emphasize transcendentals and worship-like community alignment; no negative signals apparent in public materials. Evidence: mission statements and staff testimonies.
- School Purpose and Goal: Formation and virtue-centered aims are foregrounded, with the Good Life and timeless truth guiding aims rather than solely workforce outcomes. Evidence: mission statements and byproduct-of-education statements about college readiness as a byproduct.
- Curriculum: Strong emphasis on trivium (grammar/logical/rhetoric), Great Books/Great Conversation, Latin/Greek, and history/Western civilization, with explicit language about the Great Conversation and primary sources. Evidence: Rhetoric School page; Great Conversation references; JCL page; language offerings.
- Pedagogy: A mix of contemplative and rigorous approaches, including Socratic/seminal discussion elements in higher grades and rhetoric training; formal memory work and recitation described. Evidence: Rhetoric School description; grammar/logic progression; Great Ideas references.

- Faculty: Public materials portray model teachers and mentors who integrate faith with classical practice, often highlighting personal testimony and long-tenured staff. Evidence: staff bios and faculty spotlights.
- Parents & Community: Public messaging consistently frames parents as partners/co-teachers and audiences for formation, with visible open-tour pathways and engagement opportunities. Evidence: admissions/contact materials and parent-facing resources.

Overall, CPLS aligns with a Classical framework across all six categories, with explicit signals in theology, virtue formation, grammar-logic-rhetoric pedagogy, Great Books orientation, classical languages, and parent/community partnership. The aggregate assessment remains CLASSICAL.

Notes on the source corpus

- The evaluation draws on CPLS site content (e.g., mission statements, JCL material, Great Conversation references, staff profiles, Rhetoric School descriptions) and corroborating materials that articulate classical education principles (e.g., “A Look at Classical, Christian Education – Part I” and related CPLS blog entries). The Positive/Negative keyword framework is informed by the “Six Essential Elements of a Classical School” lexicon, including the Positive keyword indicators (truth, goodness, beauty; virtue; theology; liturgy; wonder; etc.) and Negative indicators (relativism; project-based dominance; etc.).

Citations and supporting sources

- CPLS mission and truth/goodness/beauty framing; JCL and Greek language emphasis.
- Great Conversation and Great Books emphasis in curriculum.
- Language offerings (Latin/Greek) and classical education framing.
- Staff/faculty narratives and Christ-centered teaching emphasis.
- Admissions/tour and parent-community engagement language.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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